## PERSONAL INFORMATION

# Gerasimos (Jerry) SPANAKIS

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Sex Male | Date of birth 27/12/1983| Nationality Greek

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### December 2016 - ongoing

### Assistant Professor in Machine Learning & Natural Language Processing (Applied AI for Digital Regulation and Platform Analysis)

Department of Advanced Computing Sciences, Maastricht Law and Tech Lab, Maastricht University, The Netherlands

- Teaching courses on: Data Analysis, Natural Language Processing
- Supervisor of BSc/MSc theses & internships (>100 completed) and PhD Advisor (5 ongoing)
- **Researcher and applied AI expert** working at the intersection of machine learning, digital regulation and regulation-relevant technology analysis, with a focus on **AI systems (including large language models/LLMs)**, algorithmic decision-making, **information retrieval** and platform ecosystems. My work supports the analysis of digital environments and online platform behavior, including issues related to transparency, robustness, bias and accountability of AI-driven systems in regulatory and enforcement contexts such as the Digital Services Act (DSA) and AI Act.
- **Legal and regulatory NLP expert**, developing methods for the structuring, retrieval and interpretation of legal and regulatory information, including retrieval-augmented question answering, statutory and multilingual legal document retrieval, and semantic approaches to making large-scale legal and regulatory text accessible, searchable and AI-ready.
- **Member of the Maastricht Law and Tech Lab.** The Lab has as objective to conduct academic and practical research on selected research themes (e.g., digital forensics, platform compliance, algorithmic governance, **knowledge and data management for legal-tech applications**). Our work advances both the scientific understanding of AI systems and their responsible deployment in social, legal and regulatory contexts (incl. the Digital Services Act, Digital Markets Act and the AI Act), building bridges between technical innovation and societal impact.
- **Technical expert for E-enforcement Academy project II/III (EU CPC/CSN Networks) (2021-today)**, acting as tutor and expert participating in the development and implementation of tasks related to tutorials, master classes, webinars, etc. to improve the ability of authorities in the CPC/CSN networks to conduct digital/online investigations, thus, developing their market surveillance capacities. Topics of focus include algorithms, **data analysis pipelines**, tool script and internet investigations, computational research with the aim of a better detection of potential violations from platforms and assisting with enforcement
- **Winner of the 2023 Silver Award for Product Safety** for leading the research paper: *"What's wrong with this product?": Detection of product safety issues based on information consumers share online.* The Award encourages and honours innovative business initiatives and research that enhance consumer safety beyond legal requirements, through **large-scale extraction and analysis of unstructured consumer-generated text data**.

Business or sector University Education / Research

### May 2014 – November 2016

### Postdoctoral Research Associate

Department of Advanced Computing Sciences, Maastricht University, The Netherlands

- Research project: ThinkSlim! (machine learning in predicting eating behaviour).

Business or sector University Education / Research

### April 2016 – June 2016

### Visiting Researcher

Department of Computing Sciences, University of Alberta

- Recommender Systems for Higher Education

Business or sector University Education / Research

October 2013 – February 2014

### Adjunct Lecturer

Technical University of Crete, Greece

- Teaching course in Business Intelligence and Knowledge Management

Business or sector University Education / Research

October 2013 – February 2014

### Scientific Associate

Technological Institute of Crete, Greece

- Teaching courses on Introduction to Programming, and Multimedia Applications

Business or sector University Education / Research

December 2012 – August 2013

### Software Engineer/Analyst

Centre of Information Technology Support of the Hellenic Army (KEPYES)

- Analyst

Business or sector IT

October 2007 – July 2012

### Lab Instructor

School of Electrical and Computer Engineering, National Technical University of Athens

- Lab instructor for courses Neural Networks and Programming Techniques

Business or sector University Education / Research

April 2004 – December 2008

### Partner-Administrator of Computing Centre

School of Electrical and Computer Engineering, Technical University of Athens

- Administrator of Computing Centre

Business or sector University Education / Research

April 2007 – July 2012

### PhD Candidate

School of Electrical and Computer Engineering, National Technical University of Athens

- Thesis subject: Intelligent techniques in text semantic analysis and search.

Business or sector University Education / Research

## EDUCATION AND TRAINING

October 2007 – July 2012

### MSc in Civil Engineering

School of Civil Engineering, National Technical University of Athens

October 2001 – October 2006

### MSc in Electrical and Computer Engineering

School of Electrical and Computer Engineering, National Technical University of Athens

## PERSONAL SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): Greek

Other language(s)

| | UNDERSTANDING | | SPEAKING | | WRITING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Listening | Reading | Spoken interaction | Spoken production | |
| English | C2 | C2 | C2 | C2 | C2 |
| | University of Michigan Proficiency in English (C2) | | | | |
| Dutch | B1 | B1 | B1 | B1l | B1 |

Levels: A1/2: Basic user - B1/2: Independent user - C1/2 Proficient user
Common European Framework of Reference for Languages

Communication skills

- good communication skills gained through his experience as professor and researcher working in international settings.
- experience in science communication for non-experts (e.g. talks for the general public) and unpackaging complex technical knowledge to non-technical audiences.

Organisational / managerial skills

- good managerial skills having 5 years of experience as member of the I-Board of Maastricht University, responsible for building a governance model for the research domain and making decisions for critical infrastructure for research.
- supervisor of 4 PhDs (finished) and 5 (ongoing)
- PI for European Project Consortia (VOXReality 2022-2026, JUST-IN 2026-now)

Job-related skills

- Excellent knowledge of internet investigation and analysis tools and its applicability to perform market surveillance processes gained through his experience as researcher and technical expert in the topic.
- Capacity to develop and implement methods to monitor and enforce regulations online (experience in studying DSA, AI Act and similar legislative frameworks (e.g. influencer marketing))
- Strong expertise in applying NLP and semantic technologies to legal and regulatory information, including retrieval-augmented question answering, statutory and multilingual legal document retrieval, and structuring large-scale legal/regulatory text for downstream AI applications

Computer skills

- **Programming languages:** Python, Java, C, C++, SQL
- **Web Development:** HTML/CSS, JavaScript, XML/JSON
- **Data Analysis & Machine Learning:** Tableau, Power BI, R, KNIME, TensorFlow, PyTorch
- **NLP & Semantic Technologies:** large language models, retrieval-augmented generation, information retrieval, text/data mining, knowledge extraction from unstructured & semi-structured text
- **Databases:** SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB)
- **Version Control & Collaboration:** Git, SVN

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Recent Publications (selection)

- **"If I Had to Buy Just ONE: Galaxy S26 Ultra": Auditing AI-Generated Product Recommendations**. Lucas Uberti Bona-Marin, Thales Bertaglia, Giovanni Astante, Bram Rijsbosch, Gijs van Dijck, Anikó Hannák, Gerasimos Spanakis, and Konrad Kollnig. (under review)
- **WinoQueer-NL: Assessing Bias in Dutch Language Models toward LGBTQ+ Identities**. Jiska Beuk and Gerasimos Spanakis. accepted at GeBNLP 2026)
- **ChildSafeAds Shared Task 2026: Commercial Content in Child-Facing YouTube Videos**. Thales Bertaglia, Catalina Goanta, Gerasimos Spanakis, Gunes Acar. (accepted at NLLP 2026)
- **Is your AI Model Accurate Enough? The Difficult Choices Behind Rigorous AI Development and the EU AI Act.** Lucas Bona-Marin, Bram Rijsbosch, Kristof Meding, Gerasimos Spanakis, Gijs van Dijck, Konrad Kollnig. FAccT 2026
- **Evaluating LLM-Generated Legal Explanations for Regulatory Compliance in Social Media Influencer Marketing.** Haoyang Gui, Thales Bertaglia, Taylor Annabell, Catalina Goanta, Tjomme Dooper, and Gerasimos Spanakis. In Proceedings of the Natural Legal Language Processing Workshop 2025, Nov 2025
- **Linking Transparency and Accountability: Analysing The Connection Between TikTok's Terms of Service and Moderation Decisions**. Leonard Eßer, and Gerasimos Spanakis. Proceedings of Natural Legal Language Processing Workshop 2025, Nov 2025
- MATCHED: Multimodal Authorship-Attribution To Combat Human Trafficking in Escort-Advertisement Data. Vageesh Kumar Saxena, Benjamin Ashpole, Gijs Van Dijck, and Gerasimos Spanakis. In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025, Jul 2025
- **Responsible guidelines for authorship attribution tasks in NLP.** Vageesh Saxena, Aurelia Tamò-Larrieux, Gijs Van Dijck, and Gerasimos Spanakis, Ethics and Information Technology, Jan 2025
- **"The Great Data Standoff: Researchers vs. Platforms Under the Digital Services Act."** Goanta, Catalina, Savvas Zannettou, Rishabh Kaushal, Jacob van de Kerkhof, Thales Bertaglia, Taylor Annabell, Haoyang Gui, Gerasimos Spanakis, and Adriana Iamnitchi. Presentation at EWAF 2025
- **Automated Transparency: A Legal and Empirical Analysis of the Digital Services Act Transparency Database**. Rishabh Kaushal, Jacob Van De Kerkhof, Catalina Goanta, Gerasimos Spanakis, and Adriana Iamnitchi. In Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, Jun 2024
- Know When to Fuse: Investigating Non-English Hybrid Retrieval in the Legal Domain.

Antoine Louis, Gijs Dijck, and Gerasimos Spanakis (COLING 2025)

- Navigating WebAI: Training Agents to Complete Web Tasks with Large Language Models and Reinforcement Learning. Lucas-Andrei Thil, Mirela Popa, and Gerasimos Spanakis. In Proceedings of the 39th ACM/SIGAPP Symposium on Applied Computing, Aug 2024
- Fixed and Adaptive Simultaneous Machine Translation Strategies Using Adapters. Abderrahmane Issam, Yusuf Can Semerci, Jan Scholtes, and Gerasimos Spanakis. In Proceedings of the 21st International Conference on Spoken Language Translation (IWSLT 2024), Aug 2024
- **Interpretable long-form legal question answering with retrieval-augmented large language models**. Antoine Louis, Gijs Dijck, and Gerasimos Spanakis. In Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence, 2024
- Catalina Goanta, Nikolaos Aletras, Ilias Chalkidis, Sofia Ranchordas, Gerasimos Spanakis. "**Regulation and NLP (RegNLP): Taming Large Language Models**." EMNLP 2023
- Vageesh Saxena, Benjamin Bashpole, Gijs Van Dijck, Gerasimos Spanakis. "IDTraffickers: An Authorship Attribution Dataset to link and connect Potential Human-Trafficking Operations on Text Escort Advertisements." EMNLP 2023
- Fabio Barbero, Sander op den Camp, Kristian van Kuijk, Carlos Soto García-Delgado, Gerasimos Spanakis, Adriana Iamnitchi. "Multi-Modal Embeddings for Isolating Cross-Platform Coordinated Information Campaigns on Social Media." Proceedings of the 5th Symposium on Multidisciplinary International Symposium on Disinformation in Open Online Media (MISDOOM 2003)
- Vageesh Saxena, Neils Rethmeier, Gijs Van Dijck, Gerasimos Spanakis. VendorLink: An NLP approach for Identifying & Linking Vendor Migrants & Potential Aliases on Darknet Markets. (ACL2023)
- Max Fuchs, Amit Jadhav, Advaith Jaishankar, Caroline Cauffman, Gerasimos Spanakis. **"What's wrong with this product?" – Detection of product safety issues based on information consumers share online.** In Nineteenth International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Law (ICAIL 2023), June 19–23, 2023, Braga, Portugal. ACM)
- Antoine Louis, Gerasimos Spanakis. A Statutory Article Retrieval Dataset in French. In *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)* (pp. 6789-6803).
- Catalina Goanta, Gerasimos Spanakis. **The commercial unfairness of recommender systems on social media. In Artificial Intelligence and the Media**. Edward Elgar Publishing, 2022.

Current Projects

- JUST-IN (Horizon project 2026-2028, Budget 300K for UM, 1 PostDoc on Legal AI)
- Am AI right? (NWO project, 1 PhD candidate on legal Information retrieval)
- RegTech4AI (1 PhD candidate on implementing legal requirements for AI systems)
- HumanAds (1 PhD candidate on influencer marketing)
- Lead expert on the e-enforcement academy of EC: Improving the ability of authorities in the Consumer Protection Cooperation Network (CPC) to conduct online investigations

Previous Projects, Awards

- 2**022-2026** VOXReality: NLP Applications in XR environments (Budget: 703K for UM, 2 PhD projects on robust NLP and context-aware techniques)
- **2023** Lead expert on a case study "Child Influencers in the Netherlands: Practices and problems" – study conducted for the Center for Criminality Prevention and Safety (https://hetccv.nl/)
- **2020-2024** Digital Legal Studies (3 PhD projects on Machine Learning applied to legal topics: information retrieval, consumer protection, cybercrime)
- **2020-2024** Young Talent in NWO Gravitation programme 'New Science of Mental Disorders', Budget: 255K for DACS, 1 PhD project in explainable predictions for EMA data)
- **2021:** LAWNOTATION (PDI-SSH): Developing a platform to systematically analyze legal documents (Total budget: 598K)
- **2020:** Web Monetization & Social Media, funded by Mozzilla (Budget: 50K for UM)"
- **2019**: Young Talent in NWO Gravitation programme 'New Science of Mental Disorders' Budget: 255K for DACS, 1 PhD project)
- **2019**: EIT/EIT Health Innovation Activity: "ThinkSlim for Kids" (Budget: 113K euro for UM)
- 2**019**: "Dark Web Data Markets", funded by UM, Budget: 7.75K for 1 year,
- **2018**: "Safety, Awareness For Empowerment", funded by UM (Diversity and Inclusivity Grant), Budget: 10K for 1 year